



LEE'S SUPPORTERS CELEBRATE IN SEOUL

■ People celebrate after exit polls showed South Korea's Lee Jae-myung of the left-leaning Democratic Party was on track to win the presidential election in Seoul, yesterday. Lee is projected to obtain 51.7 per cent of the total votes cast, beating main conservative candidate Kim Moon-soo on 39.3 per cent.

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UAE receives IAEA's highest badge for nuclear safeguards

It is among a small group of nations that have achieved the 'Broader Conclusion'

ABU DHABI
BY ALI AL HAMMADI
Reporter

The UAE has once again received the International Atomic Energy Agency's (IAEA) highest level of recognition in its 2024 Safeguards Implementation Report, marking the third consecutive year the country has earned the "Broader Conclusion".

This achievement reaffirms that all declared nuclear material in the UAE is being used solely for peaceful purposes. It reflects the country's strong regulatory framework and continued commitment to nuclear transparency and global non-proliferation standards.

The "Broader Conclusion" is the result of a thorough review process carried out by the IAEA, based on detailed information provided by the UAE under its non-proliferation agreements. This includes regular reports on nuclear

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facilities, materials and technologies, as well as voluntary additional disclosures. The IAEA then verifies this information through inspections and assessments, also considering independent sources and open-source data.

Meeting highest standards

The UAE's ability to consistently meet the highest standards has enabled the IAEA to implement what is known as "Integrated Safeguards" in the country. This system allows for a more efficient verification process by reducing the frequency of inspections, without compromising the high level of oversight. It also underscores international confidence in the UAE's

peaceful nuclear energy programme.

"This continued recognition by the IAEA is a proud moment for the UAE and a clear signal of our ongoing dedication to using nuclear energy in a safe, transparent, and peaceful manner," said a spokesperson from the Federal Authority for Nuclear Regulation (FANR).

In 2021, the UAE took a significant step in strengthening its nuclear safeguards by completing the final part of its subsidiary arrangements with the IAEA, fully meeting its obligations under the safeguards agreement. This paved the way for deeper cooperation and further reinforced the UAE's position as a responsible user of nuclear technology.

Throughout 2024, the UAE continued to support the IAEA through its Safeguards Support Programme.

This latest recognition from the IAEA places the UAE among a small group of countries globally that have achieved the "Broader Conclusion", highlighting the country's leadership in peaceful nuclear energy development.

Musk's XChat: Are Insta, WhatsApp in danger?

It's a new private communication platform

DUBAI
BY BALARAM MENON
Senior Web Editor

Elon Musk has officially announced XChat, a new private communication platform integrated into X, as part of his broader mission to transform the social network into an all-encompassing "everything app."

XChat introduces a suite of features centred on security and privacy, including Bitcoin-style encryption, disappearing messages, and cross-platform audio/video calls — none of which require users to link a phone number. The tool is being

rolled out in beta mode for select paid subscribers, with early feedback highlighting end-to-end encrypted chats secured by a 4-digit passcode.

Direct competition?

In a post on Sunday, Musk called XChat 'all new' and emphasised its potential to rival established messaging apps like WhatsApp, Telegram, and Signal.

The launch does put X in direct competition with platforms owned by Meta, such as WhatsApp and Instagram, which are also expanding end-to-end encryption (E2EE) capabilities.

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Trump tariffs are hurting the global economy

GLOBAL FORECASTS SLASHED FOR THE SECOND TIME THIS YEAR

PARIS

Donald Trump's combative trade policies have tipped the world economy into a downturn, with the US among the hardest hit, the Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD) said.

The Paris-based body slashed its global forecasts for the second time this year, citing the impact of the American president's tariff onslaught. The combination of trade barriers and uncertainty are hitting confidence and holding back investment, it said, while also warning that protectionism is adding to inflationary pressures.

The OECD now forecasts global economic growth to slow to 2.9 per cent this year from 3.3 per cent in 2024. It expects the rate of expansion in the US will tumble further, to 1.6 per cent from 2.8 per cent — an outlook that is significantly lower than its projection in March.

Gloomy outlook

"Weakened economic prospects will be felt around the world, with almost no exception," Chief Economist Alvaro Pereira said. "Lower growth and less trade will hit incomes and slow job growth."

The assessment indicates how Trump's policies have become the most pressing problem for the global economy, with no easy solution in sight. The situation could yet be exacerbated by retaliation from US trading partners, a further erosion of confidence, or another

2.9%
Global economic growth forecast for this year

3.3%
was the global economic growth in 2024

bout of repricing on financial markets, the OECD said.

The club of 38 rich countries published its forecasts just as its members' ministers convene in Paris for an annual meeting. Top commerce officials are expected there include US trade representative Jamieson Greer and EU trade commissioner Maros Sefcovic. Lin Feng, a representative from China's Ministry of Commerce, is also scheduled to attend.

"Agreements to ease trade tensions and lower tariffs and other trade barriers will be instrumental to revive growth and investment and avoid rising prices," the OECD said. "This is by far the most important policy priority."

Yet the organisation also said that even if Trump reversed course on tariffs, the bonus in terms of growth and reduced inflation would not materialise immediately, due to a persistent drag from heightened uncertainty over policy. — Bloomberg



SPORT

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